A-A-2527A
5 July 1989
Superseding
A-A-2527
18 FEBRUARY 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

WAX, CARNAUBA

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in lieu of Federal Specification JJJ-W-141, Grade A, Type 1, refined.

This commercial item description covers refined carnauba wax.

Salient characteristics:

Material. The wax shall be a hard, amorphous, brittle, nontacky, material produced by exudation of wax palm leaves known botanically as Copernica Cerifera (Brazil).

Chemical characteristics. Carnauba wax shall conform to the chemical characteristics shown in table 1 when tested in accordance with the applicable ASTM test method. Additionally, the refined carnauba wax shall match the infra-red spectra in figure 1 exactly at 1736 um-1, 1473 um-1, 730 um-1, and 719 um-1 wave numbers.

Intended use: Carnauba wax is intended for use in polishes, finishes, cosmetics, lubricants, inks, protective coatings, medicinals, and as a food additive.

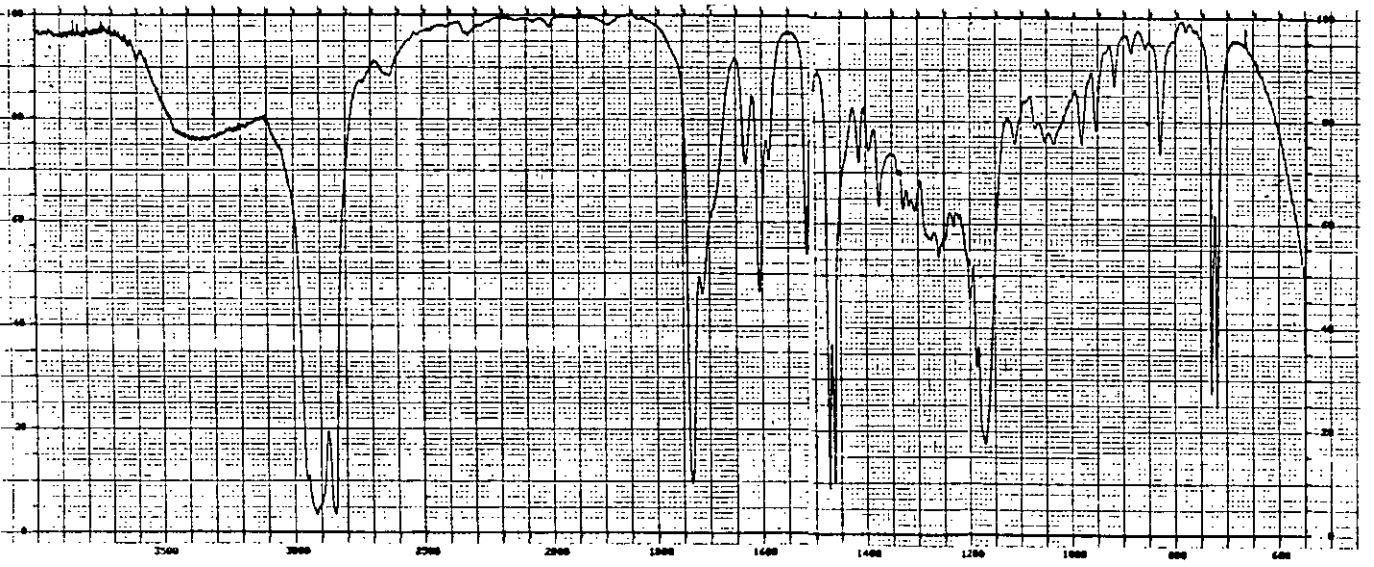
TABLE 1. Characteristics

Characteristics	Minimum	Maximum	ASTM test method
Melting point, C	83	84	F766
Needle Penetration @ 25 C	0.5mm	0.6mm	D5
Flash point, C	305 C	-	D92
Specific gravity	0.990	1.001	D71
Acid Number	2.0	10.0	D1386
Volatile matter @ 105 C, percent	-	0.5	D4209
Refractive index @ 40 C	1.467	1.472	D1747
Iodine number	-	13.7	D1959

AMSC N/A FSC 9160

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:23Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



X: 6901 4000 550 0.50 3.17 100.00T F AC4 CARNAUBA
STANDARD SAMPLE OF CARNAUBA WAX
REF: 4000 96.47 2000 99.45 4.50

3895	95.3	3877	95.5	3842	95.8	3824	95.6	3812	95.7
3790	96.2	3740	96.6	3718	96.3	3694	95.9	3678	95.6
3662	94.9	3640	94.1	3604	91.1	3391	75.8	3354	75.6
2954	9.9	2923	3.3	2919	3.2	2848	3.5	2634	88.0
2333	96.1	2019	97.6	1896	98.1	1736	9.3	1717	46.0
1699	60.8	1632	71.3	1606	46.3	1587	72.2	1515	53.7
1473	8.8	1462	10.3	1414	71.9	1396	74.0	1376	63.5
1330	63.0	1318.	63.4	1307	62.6	1276	56.8	1261	53.5
1248	56.9	1232	59.4	1223	60.7	1201	45.3	1187	32.3
1170	17.3	1113	75.5	1073	78.5	1055	75.9	1037	75.3
983	75.5	956	78.3	920	86.9	888	93.2	860	94.0
831	73.5	782	97.4	730	27.6	719	24.8	670	94.6

60 peaks found

Figure 1. Infra-red standard spectrum for refined carnauba wax.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:23Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Color. When color is specified, the wax shall be no darker than the specified color.

Workmanship. Carnauba wax shall be uniform and free of extraneous matter.

Quality assurance provisions. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any inspections set forth in the description where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure services conform to prescribed requirements.

Quality conformance inspections. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, sampling for inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be the contents of one filled shipping bag, the net weight to be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of the description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same as the product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offerer/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offerer/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army - AR

Preparing Activity:
DoD - AR

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:
GSA-FSS

Project No. 9160-1002

☆U.S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1989 - 604-033/13908

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:23Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.